

## **Sickle cell disease**

### **1. Definition.**

Sickle cell disease, also known as sickle cell anemia, is an inherited genetic disorder caused by a hemoglobin abnormality in which the normal hemoglobin (Hb) A (HbA) is replaced by an abnormal one, Hb S. It is an autosomal recessive disease: for a child to be homozygous SS", he or she must inherit an S abnormality from each parent.

### **2. Clinical manifestations**

- Anemia
- Splenomegaly
- Painful swelling of hands and feet (sd pieds mains)
- Vaso-occlusive crisis (abdominal pain, chest pain, joint pain, metaphyseal bone pain)
- Physical asthenia
- Moderate fever
- Increased susceptibility to infection
- Priapism

### **3. Support**

- Abundant oral and/or IV hydration
- Analgesics: paracetamol, aspirin, NSAIDs
- If signs of severity or no improvement in the child's condition: refer to a district hospital for better care and further investigations.